

Electricity Generation, Transmission & Distribution

Complete handbook lesson for Course 5032. It follows the official syllabus: generating systems, economics, power factor, tariffs, transmission schemes, sag, distribution systems, insulators, underground cables and substations.

4 Credits

Program Core

60 Periods

L:3 T:1 P:0

4 Chapters

CO1 to CO4

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Course Information

Program: Diploma in Electrical and Electronics Engineering. Course code: 5032. Semester: 5.
Credits: 4. Periods: 4 per week and 60 per semester.

- Introduce electricity generation plants and their economics.

Course 5032

- Familiarize students with electrical transmission and distribution systems.

Course Outcomes

- CO1: Identify generating systems and calculate electricity generated.
- CO2: Choose power factor improvement methods and list tariffs.
- CO3: Identify transmission schemes and calculate sag.
- CO4: Summarize distribution systems.

Malayalam: ഈ വിഷയം generation മുതൽ consumer distribution വരെ power system flow പഠിപ്പിക്കുന്നു.

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Module 1 · CO1 · 14 Hours

Electric Power Generating Systems

Energy source classification, commercial/non-commercial generation, hydroelectric station, thermal stations, site selection, hydel calculations, interconnected grid, distributed generation and microgrid.

Energy sources and methods

Electricity is produced by converting water energy, fuel heat, nuclear heat or renewable energy into electrical output through a generator. Conventional sources include coal, diesel, gas, nuclear and hydro. Renewable sources include solar, wind, biomass and small hydro.

Malayalam: Water, coal, gas, diesel തുടങ്ങിയ sources mechanical rotation ആക്കി alternator വഴി electricity ഉണ്ടാക്കുന്നു.

Hydroelectric plant

Stored water flows through a penstock, rotates a turbine and drives an alternator. Hydel plants have low running cost and quick starting, but depend on rainfall and suitable site.

$$P = 9.81 Q H \eta \text{ kW}$$

Thermal plants

Coal, gas, diesel and nuclear stations use heat energy to produce mechanical rotation. Coal and nuclear plants are base-load suited; gas and diesel are useful for peak or standby operation.

Grid and microgrid

Interconnected grids improve reliability and economy. Distributed generation places sources near loads. A microgrid can operate with the main grid or independently during grid failure.

Module 2 · CO2 · 15 Hours

Load Curve, Cost, Power Factor and Tariffs

Variable load, load curve, load duration curve, demand terms, generation costs, power factor correction and tariff schemes.

Load curve

Load curve shows demand versus time. The area under the curve gives energy. It helps decide base load, peak load, reserve capacity and economic operation.

Malayalam: Load curve demand എപ്പോൾ കൂടുന്നു കുറയുന്നു എന്ന് കാണിക്കുന്നു.

Demand terms

Connected load, average demand, maximum demand, load factor and diversity factor are used for power station and distribution planning.

$$\text{Load factor} = \text{Average demand} / \text{Maximum demand}$$

Power factor improvement

Low power factor increases current, losses, voltage drop and equipment rating. Static capacitors, synchronous condensers and phase advancers improve power factor.

$$Q_c = P(\tan\phi_1 - \tan\phi_2)$$

Tariffs

Simple, flat rate, block rate, two-part, three-part, maximum demand, power factor, ABT and TOD tariffs are used for billing and demand management.

Module 3 · CO3 · 15 Hours

Transmission Systems and Sag

Primary/secondary transmission, AC/DC transmission, overhead lines, conductors, losses, regulation, sag, transposition, skin effect, proximity effect, Ferranti effect, corona, EHV, HVDC and FACTS.

Transmission schemes

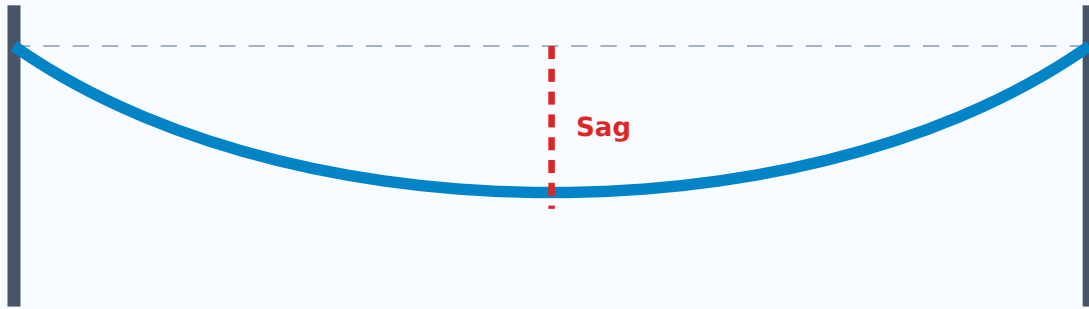
Transmission carries bulk power from generating stations to receiving stations. AC transmission is common due to easy transformation. DC transmission is useful for special long-distance and interconnection cases.

Overhead line components

Conductors, supports, insulators, cross-arms, clamps, earth wires and protective accessories form the overhead line system.

Sag and tension

Sag is the vertical distance between the lowest conductor point and the line joining supports. Correct sag gives safe clearance without excessive tension.



Sag equation for equal-level supports: $y = wL^2 / 8T$.

Module 4 · CO4 · 14 Hours

Distribution Systems, Insulators, Cables and Substations

Feeder, distributor, service mains, radial/ring/interconnected systems, DC/AC distribution, ideal system, insulators, string efficiency, underground cables and substations.

Distribution components

Feeder carries power from substation to the area. Distributor gives tappings to consumers. Service mains connect distributor to consumer premises.

Malayalam: Feeder supply area വരര, distributor consumers-ലേക്ക് tapping, service mains final connection.

Distribution schemes

Radial system is simple but less reliable. Ring main improves continuity. Interconnected system provides high reliability but protection is complex.

Insulators and cables

Insulators support conductors and prevent leakage. Underground cables have conductor, insulation, sheath, bedding, armouring and serving.

$$\text{String efficiency} = V_{\text{string}} / (n \times V_{\text{max disc}}) \times 100\%$$

Substation

A substation changes voltage level, switches circuits, protects equipment and controls power flow using transformers, busbars, circuit breakers, isolators, CT, PT, relays and lightning arresters.

Formula Bank

$$P = 9.81QH\eta$$

Hydel power in kW.

$$\text{Energy} = \text{Power} \times \text{Time}$$

kWh calculation.

$$LF = \text{Average demand} / \text{Maximum demand}$$

Load factor.

$$DF = \Sigma \text{ individual max demand} / \text{system max demand}$$

Diversity factor.

$$Q_c = P(\tan\phi_1 - \tan\phi_2)$$

Capacitor kVAR.

$$y = wL^2 / 8T$$

Worked Examples

Hydel power

$Q=20$, $H=40$, $\eta=0.85$. $P=9.81 \times 20 \times 40 \times 0.85 = 6670.8 \text{ kW}$.

6.67 MW

Load factor

Average demand = 300 kW, max demand = 500 kW. $LF = 300/500$.

60%

Capacitor rating

100 kW at 0.7 improved to 0.95. $Q_c = 100(1.020 - 0.329)$.

69.1 kVAr

Sag

$w=0.8 \text{ kg/m}$, $L=200 \text{ m}$, $T=2000 \text{ kg}$. $y = 0.8 \times 200^2 / (8 \times 2000)$.

2 m

Question Bank

2 and 5 Mark

1. Define load factor.
2. What is sag?
3. List two PF improvement methods.
4. Define feeder and distributor.
5. Explain load curve and its importance.
6. Compare radial and ring main distribution.
7. Explain skin effect and corona.
8. Write short note on underground cable construction.

10 and 15 Mark

1. Explain hydroelectric power plant with schematic diagram.
2. Explain power factor correction using capacitors.
3. Explain sag calculation and its significance.
4. Explain distribution schemes, insulators, cables and substations.

Model Question Paper

Time: 3 Hours · **Maximum Marks:** 100

1. Define base load and peak load.
2. Explain hydroelectric generation with diagram.
3. Calculate hydel power for $Q=25 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$, $H=60 \text{ m}$ and $\eta=0.82$.
4. Calculate capacitor kVAR for a 250 kW load at 0.75 improved to 0.95.
5. Explain overhead line components and sag.
6. Explain underground cable construction and substation single-line diagram.

Answer Key

Hydel equation

$$P=9.81QH\eta \text{ kW.}$$

Hydel problem

$$P=9.81 \times 25 \times 60 \times 0.82 = 12066.3 \text{ kW.}$$

12.07 MW

Capacitor problem

$$Q_c = 250(0.882 - 0.329).$$

138.25 kVAR